

Chapter-5

Speech

A speech is a formal address or discourse delivered to an audience. A speech seeks to convince, persuade, inspire or inform. The main purpose of the speech is to convey the speaker's message in such an effective way as may greatly influence the audience. History is full of examples where speeches made by great orators brought about great revolutions. Mark Antony's speech in Shakespeare's 'Julius Caesar' and Portia's speech on mercy in Shakespeare's 'Merchant of Venice', Satan's speech in John Milton's 'Paradise Lost' are examples of some famous speeches in literature.

Great oratory has three components.

Style: A great speech must be masterfully constructed. The best orators are masters of both the written and spoken word, and use words to create texts that are beautiful to both hear and read.

Substance: A speech may be flowery and charismatically presented, and yet lack any true substance at all. Great oratory must centre on a worthy theme; it must appeal to and inspire the audience's finest values and ideals.

Impact: Great oratory always seeks to persuade the audience of some fact or idea. The very best speeches change hearts and minds and seem as revelatory several decades or centuries removed as when they were first given.

Layout of a Speech

1. Introduction:

- ✦ Welcome, Greeting and Formal Address: First of all, the speaker is required to welcome, greet and formally address the audience. The names of the addressees should be in correct sequence of institutional hierarchy. For example: Address the Principal first, and then teachers and fellow students. Don't forget to mention the chief guests, dignitaries and other people who are a part of the audience in the very beginning of your speech.
- ✦ Introduce yourself telling your name, class, section and/or designation.
- ✦ Introduce the topic or theme on which you are going to speak. You may introduce the topic by sharing an anecdote, giving an example, citing a quotation, quoting some statistics in the very beginning of your speech and then moving ahead with the rest of introduction.

2. Body:

- ✦ Provide information on various aspects of the theme you have selected to speak on. The information may consist of arguments, examples, definitions, descriptions, comparisons, quotations, facts supported with statistics etc.
- ✦ Present your views in a logical sequence using appropriate cohesive devices and transitional words and expressions.

3. Conclusion:

- ✦ Sum up your views and conclude your speech.
- ✦ You may end by inspiring the audience to think and act in a particular way, warning the audience, or by asking questions for the audience to ponder over or answer.
- ✦ End with formal thanks by saying 'Thank you', 'Thank you everyone' or 'Thank you for the patient hearing'.

Tips for Writing an Effective Speech

1. Consider your audience.
2. Collect information relevant to the topic or theme of your speech.
3. Organise the information in a logical sequence and prepare a rough draft.
4. Keep the time limit in mind.
5. Keep the language conversational by using appropriate cohesive devices and by applying appropriate stress, tone and intonation. Use a variety of sentences: Affirmative, Negative, Questions, Imperative, Exclamatory and Optative to make the speech as communicative as possible. Read the golden rules given below to add an extra pinch of spice to your speech.
 - ✦ **Rule of 3:** The human brain responds magically to things that come in threes. Whether it's a list of adjectives, a joke, or your main points, it's most effective if you keep it to this structure.
 - ✦ **Imagery:** Metaphors, similes and description will help an audience understand you, and keep them entertained.
 - ✦ **Pronouns:** Use "we" to create a sense of unity, "them" for a common enemy, "you" if you're reaching out to your audience, and "I" / "me" if you want to take control.
 - ✦ **Poetry:** Repetition, rhyme and alliteration are sound effects, used by poets and orators alike. They make a speech much more memorable. Also remember to structure pauses and parentheses into a speech. This will vary the flow of sound, helping you hold your audience's attention.
 - ✦ **Jokes:** Humour is powerful. Use it to perk up a sleepy audience, as well as a rhetorical tool. Laughter is based on people having common, shared assumptions – and can therefore be used to persuade.
6. Edit the rough draft and remove grammatical or spelling errors. Try to replace the same words with synonyms. Conclude effectively and urge the audience to take required action. End with a hope or positive statement.
7. Thank your audience.

Some Useful Phrases or Sentences

1. I am sure all of you will agree if I say.....
2. There is no doubt that.....
3. What would happen if.....
4. You all must have heard that.....
5. As you all know that.....
6. Let me relate an anecdote at this point.....
7. There would be no exaggeration if I say.....
8. It is a proven fact that.....
9. Don't you think that.....?
10. As far as I believe.....
11. I strongly believe that.....
12. Let's take the example of.....
13. You will be stunned to know that.....
14. The matter of the fact is that.....
15. On the contrary.....

16. I would also like to tell/inform you that.....
17. You will be delighted/surprised/shocked to learn that.....
18. Do you know that.....?
19. All of you must have heard the saying.....
20. You won't believe that.....

Speech Sample-1

Swami Vivekananda's Speech at the Chicago Convention of Parliament of Religions

Sisters and Brothers of America,

It fills my heart with joy unspeakable to rise in response to the warm and cordial welcome which you have given us. I thank you in the name of the most ancient order of monks in the world; I thank you in the name of the mother of religions, and I thank you in the name of millions and millions of Hindu people of all classes and sects.

My thanks, also, to some of the speakers on this platform who, referring to the delegates from the Orient, have told you that these men from far-off nations may well claim the honour of bearing to different lands the idea of toleration. I am proud to belong to a religion which has taught the world both tolerance and universal acceptance. We believe not only in universal toleration, but we accept all religions as true. I am proud to belong to a nation which has sheltered the persecuted and the refugees of all religions and all nations of the earth. I am proud to tell you that we have gathered in our bosom the purest remnant of the Israelites, who came to Southern India and took refuge with us in the very year in which their holy temple was shattered to pieces by Roman tyranny. I am proud to belong to the religion which has sheltered and is still fostering the remnant of the grand Zoroastrian nation. I will quote to you, brethren, a few lines from a hymn which I remember to have repeated from my earliest boyhood, which is every day repeated by millions of human beings: "As the different streams having their sources in different paths which men take through different tendencies, various though they appear, crooked or straight, all lead to Thee."

The present convention, which is one of the most august assemblies ever held, is in itself a vindication, a declaration to the world of the wonderful doctrine preached in the Geeta: "Whosoever comes to me, through whatsoever form, I reach him; all men are struggling through paths which in the end lead to me." Sectarianism, bigotry, and its horrible descendant, fanaticism, have long possessed this beautiful earth. They have filled the earth with violence, drenched it often and often with human blood, destroyed civilization and sent whole nations to despair. Had it not been for these horrible demons, human society would be far more advanced than it is now. But their time is come; and I fervently hope that the bell that tolled this morning in honour of this convention may be the death-knell of all fanaticism, of all persecutions with the sword or with the pen, and of all uncharitable feelings between persons wending their way to the same goal.

Speech Sample-2

Write a speech on the topic 'Importance of Discipline in Our Life'.

Have you ever imagined what would happen if the earth stopped moving around the sun or the sun stopped giving heat and light to the world?

Honourable Principal, worthy teachers and my dear friends. A very good morning to all of you. I am Ankita Sinha of grade VI A. Today I stand before you to express my views on the importance of discipline in our lives.

Since the creation of this universe, the earth has been moving around the sun, the sun has been spreading its bright rays to one and all without any discrimination, the pole star has been guiding the travellers and the trees have been providing us Oxygen. All the objects, living or non-living maintain a strict discipline. Life would be chaotic in the absence of discipline. To be disciplined is to submit to a good rule or system, to maintain certain restraints for ultimate general good. If discipline is violated, steps must be taken against the offender.

Discipline is necessary in all spheres of life. An army cannot fight without strict discipline. An educational institution cannot run without discipline. Teachers and students must come to the school at a fixed hour every day, and observe the rules of the institution. Courts, offices, auditoriums, and even private houses have to maintain discipline. One cannot go into a hospital at hours when visitors are not allowed. One has to stand in a queue to pay bills for electricity or telephone, or for buying tickets for cinema or train journey.

In personal life, too, one has to practice discipline for a stable and worthy life. If you give in to temptations and overeat yourself, the stomach will revolt. If you watch TV throughout night, you will get sick the next day. If you do not restrain yourself from music and story-books before the examinations, you are sure to fare ill. Similarly, one cannot enjoy any sport if one is not disciplined as discipline is the very soul of any sport.

In fact, life is best enjoyed only if discipline is maintained. Nothing can be properly enjoyed, not even a game of cricket or a musical concert, if indiscipline is allowed to invade it. Therefore, we should all try to maintain discipline in our lives.

Thank you. Have a great day!

1. Write a speech on the topic ‘Drug Addiction’. You may find the following hints useful.



Hints: Explain the meaning of drug addiction, types of drugs, people responsible, ill effects on physical, mental and emotional health, attitude of parents, peers, friends, how to get rid of drug addiction, role of government and administration

[illegible]

2. Write a speech on the topic ‘Importance of Physical Education’. You may find the following hints useful.



Hints: healthy body, healthy mind, physical fitness, blood circulation, metabolism, energy channelized, team spirit, great pastime, discipline, stress management, career opportunities, physical, emotional and mental strength, role of teachers and school administration

[illegible]

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

4. Write a speech on the topic ‘Blessings of a Joint Family’. You may find the following hints useful.



Hints: Types of family, structure of joint family, security, entertainment, financial and moral support in times of emergency, blessings of grandparents, experience, better rearing of kids, strong bond, social status, no need of old age home, counselling, beneficial for all

[illegible]

5. Write a speech on the topic 'Save Water'. You may find the following hints useful.



Hints: Importance of water in routine life, drinking, bathing, washing clothes, cleaning, scarcity of usable or drinkable water, falling water level of ground water, drying rivers, melting glaciers, sea water, ways to save water, rain water harvesting, judicious use of water, reuse of water for gardening, turn off taps when

[illegible]

6. Write a speech on the topic ‘Friends Are the Lifelines’. You may find the following hints useful.



Hints: playing and studying together, helpful in need, share joys, sorrows and secrets, great company, learn from one another, teach moral values, complement one another, as important as family, teach how to maintain a social life, counsel, keep away from bad habits, keep one emotionally fit

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